

Day 1 — The Moon Story

Module: Moon Phases & Tithi (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Children meet the Moon as a ball that the Sun lights up, and understand at a basic level why it changes shape.

Materials

- A torch (flashlight)
- A small white ball (a table-tennis ball or styrofoam ball)
- The room dark enough that the torch beam is visible

The flow

Settle + question (3 min)

Sit on the mat. Teacher: “*Today we are going to meet the Moon.*”

Quick question round: “*Did you see the Moon last night? What shape was it?*” Take 4–5 answers, sketch each one on the board.

The story (8 min)

The Moon is a ball.

Imagine a giant white ball, very far away in the sky. That ball is the Moon. It does not make its own light — it is a dark, rocky ball.

Then the Sun shines on it. The Sun is so bright that one half of the Moon lights up. (Hold up the white ball; shine the torch on one side.) Look — half of this ball is bright, and half is dark.

Now — the Moon doesn’t stay still. It travels around the Earth — that’s us. (Walk slowly around a stationary child, holding the ball at arm’s length.)

As the Moon travels, sometimes we see all of the lit side, sometimes only half of the lit side, sometimes none of the lit side. That’s why the Moon looks different every night.

When we see ALL of the lit side, that’s a *pūrṇimā* — a full moon.

When we see NONE of the lit side, that’s an *amāvasyā* — a new moon. The Moon is still there — we just can’t see it.

The demo (12 min)

Set up: - One child stands in the centre = Earth. - Another child holds the torch = Sun. - The teacher walks the ball around Earth in 4 stopping points: 1. Ball between Sun and Earth → Earth sees the dark side (*amāvasyā*). 2. Ball 90° away → Earth sees half lit (half Moon). 3. Ball

opposite the Sun → Earth sees full lit (*pūrṇimā*). 4. Ball 90° away on the other side → Earth sees half lit (other half Moon).

At each stop, ask the Earth-child: “*What do you see?*” The class chorus-answers.

Repeat with a few other children rotating roles. Spend the full 12 minutes — children love this and need the repetition.

Word practice (4 min)

Chant 3 times together (clap on each syllable):

am - mah - vāh - yah — the night with no Moon *poor - ni - mah* — the night with the full Moon

Wrap-up (3 min)

- Each child draws one Moon shape on paper — whichever shape they remember best from the demo.
- Hold up 3 drawings.
- **Homework:** *Look at the Moon tonight. Whatever shape you see, draw it in your workbook. If it's cloudy, ask a grown-up to look it up on a phone.*

Homework / take-home

- **Start your Moon Diary tonight.** Look up. Draw what you see. Note: clear or cloudy.

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Draw two phases (last night's + tonight's predicted).
- **Tier down:** Just remember the word *pūrṇimā* (the easier one). *Amāvasyā* can come later this week.

Teacher's quick notes

- The single most important sentence today: “**The Sun lights the Moon. The Moon doesn't make its own light.**” Repeat it often.
- Some children will need the demo repeated. That's fine — that's the whole class.
- Don't worry about Sanskrit spelling. They'll get it through repetition over the week.